

pfSense: The Popular Open Source Firewall

pfSense.org has an interesting slogan: "We make network security easy." With thousands of enterprises using pfSense software, it is rapidly becoming the world's most popular open source network security solution. pfSense is indeed an excellent firewall.



pfSense software is a customised distribution of FreeBSD, specifically tailored for use as a firewall and router that is primarily managed via a Web interface. In addition to being a powerful, flexible firewall and routing platform, it includes a long list of related features and a package system that allows further expandability, without adding bloat to the base distribution.

The pfSense project was started in September 2004 by Chris Buehler and Scott Ullrich, with a growing development team. pfSense and its current logo is a copyright of Electric Sheep Fencing LLC.

Apart from pfSense downloads, *pfSense.org* also provides firewall appliances based on pfSense to cater to a variety of customer requirements. Other offerings include product support, professional services, official training via

'pfSense university' and gold membership. pfSense also has great community support.

The latest pfSense version 2.3 was released on April 12, 2016. Some interesting functional changes over the earlier version are:

- Drag-and-drop rule reordering enabled for firewall and NAT rules.
- Live CD support no more available. Live boot using a USB drive.
- Removal of support for unsecured protocols such as Single DES Encryption, Wired Equivalence Privacy (WEP) for wireless encryption, etc.

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